PANELTEC PTY LTD

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SWMS-28

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	**Supervisor/Foreman**	**Date:**	
High Risk Construction Work:	**NON-DESTRUCTIVE LOCATING – VACUUM - POTHOLE**	**Project:**	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group - Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. *SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier* **Signature:** ______		**Location:**	

Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"

John Guy	Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd	0408 449 023	______	31/08/2025 – V12.0
Name	**Position**	☎	**Signature**	**Date**

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L *Likely*	M *Moderate*	U *Unlikely*
H (1) *(High level of harm)*	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) *(High)*	1	1	2
M (2) *(Medium level of harm)*	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) *(Medium)*	1	2	3
L (3) *(Low level of harm)*	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) *(Low)*	2	3	3

Level	Likelihood / Probability
Likely	Could happen frequently
Moderate	Could happen occasionally
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 **Eliminate the hazard**
Level 2 **Substitute the hazard with something safer.**
Level 3 **Isolate the hazard from people.** **Reduce the risks through engineering controls.**
Level 4 **Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.**
Level 5 **Use personal protective equipment**
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Training and skill.	Un-trained persons could cause injury to themselves and others.	**1**	1. All persons working on site must carry with them a current 'Construction Induction Card'. 2. All persons working on site must be suitably trained and competent in the task they are to perform. 3. Workers to be adequately supervised.	Supervisor All	**2**
Personal Protective Clothing & Equipment (PPE)	Bodily injuries Spills and splashes onto workers' eyes / skin	**1**	1. Before starting work on site check available PPE is adequate for all tasks to be under taken and in good working condition including; safety boots, safety glasses, ear muffs and other protective clothing & equipment as required.	Supervisor All	**2**
Operating plant	Plant failure	**1**	1. Pre start check to be completed prior to start of works each day. 2. Plant to be properly maintained and checked before use.	Supervisor Plant Operators	**2**
Perform a Site Hazard Assessment and determine the location of where the hole is to be dug	Various including serious illness.	**1**	1. On arrival at site complete a site hazard assessment by using this SWMS as a checklist. 2. Implement control measures to mitigate risk to persons on site.	Supervisor	**2**
	Striking underground services - electrocution	**1**	1. Before digging starts, make sure you know the exact location of any underground electrical cables, gas lines, water, sewerage and telecommunications cables 2. Do not rely solely on site plans and drawings as these are sometimes not accurate or complete. 3. Seek assistance from the local services and distribution companies. 4. Use "Before You Dig Australia" **Emergency Procedure to be used:** ➢ If the contact point is under the ground there is an area around that point which can be electrified. ➢ Jump well clear of that point and move away from the machine and warn others to keep away ➢ Stay near the site until help arrives ➢ Report the incident to your supervisor immediately who may need to report to WorkCover.	Supervisor	**2**

Steps in Activity	**Potential Hazards**	**Risk Class**	**Risk Control Measure**	**Responsible Person/s**	**Risk Class After Controls In Place**
Site setup	Injury to operator or bystanders – high pressure- dirt and stones can be flicked around.	**1**	1. Keep operating area clear of all persons. 2. Use a witch's hat next to the water jet to prevent splashes. 3. Stay alert and beware of the force of the water pressure coming out the end of the hose (around 3000psi) and when using the vacuum hose be aware of the suction pressure. 4. Never aim the jet in the direction of persons or animals as the water jet comes out of the nozzle at high speed with high pressure. 5. Do not leave the unit unattended. If the unit is not required switch it off. 6. Do not operate the unit in enclosed spaces. 7. Follow directions as per the operations manual. 8. The pressure hose is operated with by trigger action.	Supervisor Operator	2
Set up hoses and pressure washer	Manual Handling tasks may cause sprains, strains, back injury & muscle fatigue.	2	1. Warm up exercises to be done prior to start of shift. 2. Appropriate manual handling techniques to be applied. 3. All workers trained in the correct lifting techniques and correct use of tools. 4. If an item appears to be too heavy or awkward ask for assistance from a crew member prior to moving the item. 5. Try not to twist your body when carrying hoses use your feet to change direction. 6. Be aware of awkward areas. 7. Use a rope to control hose where required.	Workers	**3**
Commence the digging & locating process	Manual Handling tasks may cause sprains, strains, back injury & muscle fatigue. Unsafe use of pressure washer – refer to safety controls below	**2**	1. Make small incision into ground with shovel. 2. Place vacuum hose in small hole. 3. Start vacuum truck. 4. Start pressure washer. 5. Use the pressure washer to cut the dirt in the hole while using the vacuum truck to suck slurry out of the hole, continue to do this digging deeper until service is located. 6. Once service is located stop pressure washer. 7. Remove any other slurry from the hole with vacuum truck. 8. Remove vacuum truck hose from hole.	Workers Plant Operators	**3**

Steps in Activity	**Potential Hazards**	**Risk Class**	**Risk Control Measure**	**Responsible Person/s**	**Risk Class After Controls In Place**
			9. Measure hole depth and cut piece of poly pipe approximately one meter longer than hole depth. 10. Write hole depth with marker on poly pipe and place poly pipe into hole. 11. Pack up pressure washer and vacuum truck and move to next location. **Repeat process**.		
Additional Safety Hazards	Trip, slip hazards.	**2**	1. Clear any obstacles from around work areas before work progresses. 2. Keep access ways clear of trip hazards.	Workers	**3**
	UV Exposure; skin cancer.	**1**	1. Be sun smart wear a broad brimmed hat, sun/safety glasses, sun protective clothing and 30+ sunscreen.	Workers	**2**
	Vehicle access Collisions with vehicles or pedestrians.	**1**	1. Drive only in designated access routes. 2. Do not park vehicles where it will create a hazard to public vehicles or pedestrians.	Workers	**2**
	Injury from incorrect use of pressure washer	**2**	**NEVER:** • Never point the nozzle of the gun close to any parts of your body or to somebody else. • Never point the nozzle of the gun closer to any breakable or fragile parts of the equipment. • Never use when there are leaks in the hose or fittings. • Never spray when you are not in a good position to hold the gun properly. • Never spray when the water tank is run dry. **ALWAYS:** • Always keep your balance - support your body with your legs. • Always grip the handle of the gun firmly before pulling the trigger. • Always counteract the high pressure spray force by securely positioning your hand and feet. • Always stop spraying when you feel fatigue and unsure of what you are doing. • Always keep a distance from you to your work. • Always wear a full face shield or eye protection.		**3**

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	**Hazard**	**Risk Class**	**Risk Control Measure**	**Responsible Person/s**	**Risk Class after Controls in place**
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	**1**	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	**2**
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	**2**	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	**3**
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	**2**	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	**3**
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	**2**	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	**3**
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	**1**	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	**2**
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	**1**	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	**2**

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	**2**	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	**3**
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	**1**	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	**2**
Visual Impact **Litter and Amenities** **Waste Management**	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	**2**	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste products will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	**3**

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.			
• All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card			
• If required Client Site Induction • Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	• Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	• Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	• Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management
• First Aid certificate training	• Manual Handling training	• Fire Extinguisher training	• Fatigue Management Training

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)			
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022, and the Environmental Pollution and Control Act 1994.			
Codes of Practice			
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

WORK ACTIVITY BRIEFING

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.